

(money) that you think is a sure thing when in fact it is quite tenuous.

Samuel never did well academically in school, but he was an excellent athlete. His talent earned him an athletic scholarship to Penn State University. Being on the football team gave him a social status, and Samuel found himself living an active social life in between practices and games. He also joined the Phi Delta Theta fraternity, which added to his social opportunities. His credit cards allowed him to routinely charge \$50 bar tabs for his friends and to spend Spring Break in Miami. Without his credit cards, it would have meant “social death.”

Samuel’s scholarship paid for tuition and a portion of his room and board, but all other expenses were his responsibility. His father had always preached, “If you can’t afford it, don’t buy it.” This advice was for other people though, certainly not for someone on their way to playing professional football and earning millions of dollars.

Between Samuel’s social life and the time he devoted to football, he found little time for studying. His grades soon started to plummet. Samuel didn’t worry. Since he was a football star, he didn’t believe that the university would let him fail. Unfortunately, his confidence was not warranted. Soon, his academic advisor informed him that if his grades didn’t improve, he would lose his scholarship. Samuel started studying hard for the first time, but unfortunately it was too late. He was already so far behind that he couldn’t catch up. He was put on academic probation and lost his scholarship.

With his scholarship money no longer available to him, Samuel didn’t have the money to pay his credit card bills. Summer break was approaching and his roommate, who was on the football team, came up with an idea for a summer business venture. They would coach a summer football camp for

